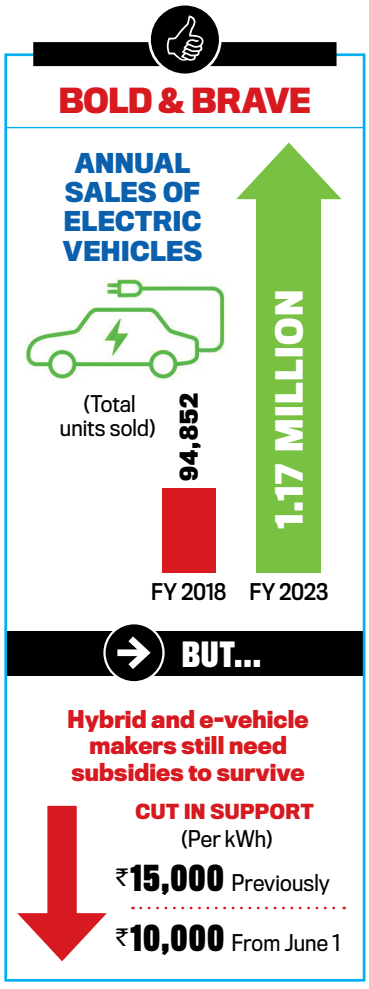
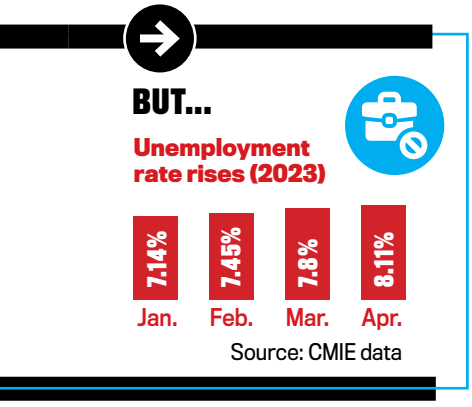




terms of statutory minimum wage, social security and healthcare.

The National Career Service portal, launched in July 2015, acts as a one-stop solution for career-related services, including job search, career counselling, vocational guidance, information on job fairs and skilling programmes, free of cost. In FY23, the platform registered 3.6 million vacancies. ■

INDUSTRY, TEXTILES

ENABLING MOVES

The PLI scheme gives the beleaguered textiles sector timely relief; open digital network promises a level-playing field in e-commerce

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

FOR THE NEXT PHASE of the production-linked incentive scheme, the Piyush Goyal-led textiles ministry is working out the modalities with a projected outlay of Rs 4,307 crore for manufacturing of garments, made-ups and textiles accessories. In the first phase, 64 projects are in different stages of implementation with an outlay commitment of Rs 10,683 crore over a five-year period. The assistance was to enable these factories to achieve size and scale, and become globally competitive.

The labour-intensive sector is battling increasing labour costs, headwinds in the West, and complexities generated by cheaper imports. Despite plugs like anti-dumping duties on inputs, the industry continues to complain that Chinese players are using the ASEAN FTA to break into Indian markets. The worst impacted are the viscose players, who face challenges from the cheaper imported alternatives. However, India is building the infrastructure to assist its players. This includes the seven PM MITRA (Pradhan Mantri Mega Integrated Textile Region and Apparel) parks in seven states. Goyal calls the scheme a massive push, which will bring together PM Narendra Modi's conception of 5Fs—farm to fibre, fibre to factory, factory to fashion, and fashion to foreign—in one place.

Piyush Goyal
Minister of Industry, Textiles

In the commerce and industry ministry, Goyal's biggest move has been the setting up of the open network for digital commerce or ONDC. It is marketed as a UPI-like product for e-commerce, allowing small retailers to join it almost for free. Now that the ministry is finalising the draft for the new e-commerce policy, it is expected to eliminate the grey areas to curb foreign-based marketplaces and retailers, and increase acceptability of ONDC among domestic sellers. ■

